

TRUSTMRR FULL DATASET · SESSION 3 · FROZEN 30 JUL 2026

Inside the Micro-SaaS Economy

What 8,782 tracked startups reveal about growth, geography and valuation in the bootstrapped software market

A large, noisy market — with a very concentrated core

The dataset tracks 8,782 revenue-generating startups synced live from payment providers. The headline finding: total activity is large, but value is captured by a small elite, and how a company monetizes (B2B vs. B2C, geography, category) matters more than how visible it is.

\$247.0M

Trailing 12-month revenue across all 8,782 tracked startups

69.5%

Share of total MRR held by just the top 1% of startups (87 companies)

57%

Of startups report \$0 in current monthly revenue — pre-revenue or stalled

2.7x

Higher revenue-per-visitor for B2B startups vs. B2C peers

What this means for decision-makers

- Averages mislead in a power-law market — benchmark against the median and the top decile, not the mean.
- B2B monetization efficiency and category conversion rates are stronger signals of quality than follower counts or domain authority.
- The acquisition market (22% of listings) prices rationally on realized revenue — asking price tracks MRR with 0.81 correlation.

What TrustMRR tracks, and how to read it

■ What the dataset is

TrustMRR is a public leaderboard of indie and bootstrapped software startups that connect a payment provider (Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, etc.) to display live, verified revenue. This export is a frozen snapshot of the full directory as of 30 Jul 2026 — 8,782 records across 29 fields, covering revenue, growth, audience, category, and (for a subset) acquisition listings.

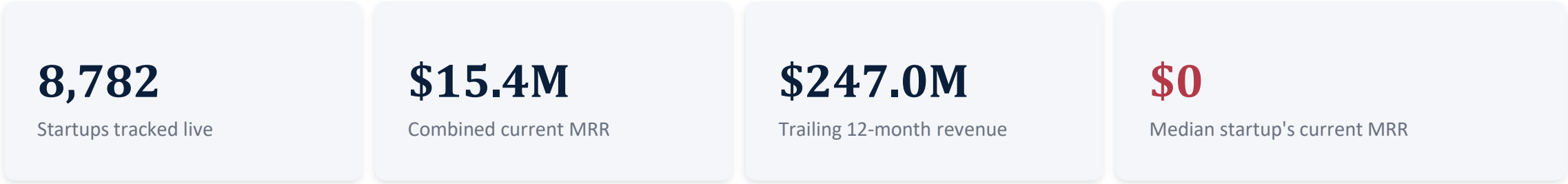
■ Field groups in this export

Identity & reach	name, URL, website, country, X followers, domain rating
Revenue & growth	30-day / 3-month / 12-month / all-time revenue, MRR, growth %
Business model	pricing, persona, audience type (B2B/B2C), category, markets
Acquisition market	on-sale flag, asking price, revenue multiple

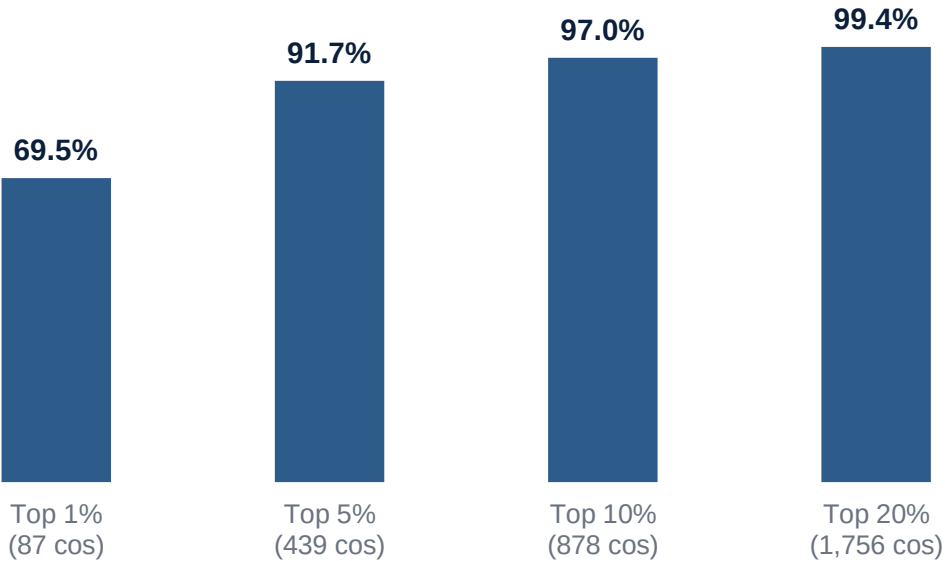
■ Read this data with three caveats

- Self-reported categories & audience type: 3,264 of 8,782 records (37%) have no category tag, and similar gaps exist for pricing model, persona and audience — these fields are founder-submitted, not mandatory.
- 555 listings (6.3% of records, but 27% of all MRR) are unnamed “Stealth Company” entries — meaningful revenue with no attached identity, category or country.
- “Frozen” snapshot: figures reflect one sync date. Growth % fields are volatile at small revenue bases and are floored throughout this deck to companies with \$5K+ MRR to avoid outlier distortion.

Scale is real — but it's a power-law market, not a bell curve



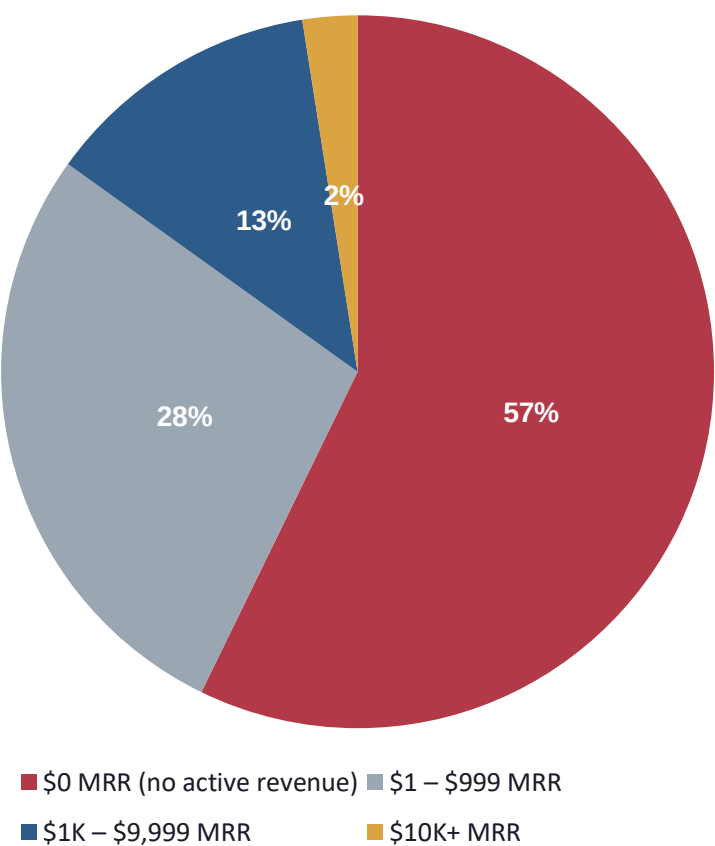
■ Cumulative share of total MRR by top-ranked startups



Reading the curve

- 87 startups (roughly one in a hundred) generate 69.5% of all tracked MRR.
- The remaining ~99% of the directory splits the last 30.5% between them.
- 5,025 startups — 57% of the dataset — currently show \$0 MRR, which is why the median collapses to zero while the mean (\$1,752) still looks healthy.
- Implication: use top-decile and category benchmarks for planning, never the dataset average.

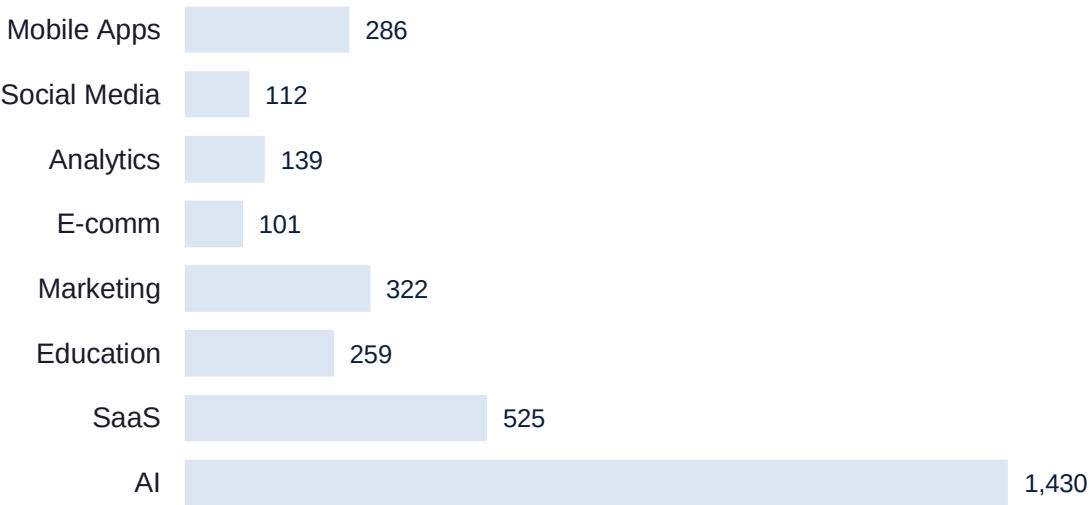
Most listings are aspirational; revenue concentrates fast



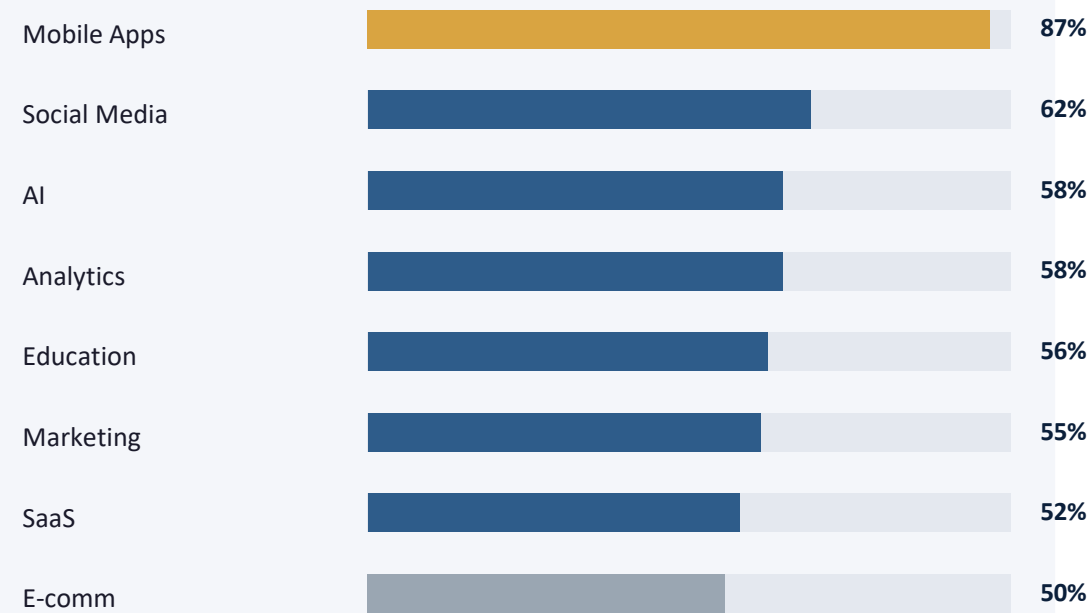
What sits inside each tier	
\$0 MRR 5,025 startups (57%)	Pre-revenue, between billing cycles, or discontinued — the long tail of the directory.
\$1–\$999 2,431 startups (28%)	Early traction: first paying customers, not yet a sustainable business.
\$1K–\$9,999 1,108 startups (13%)	Proven demand; the zone most acquirers and operators benchmark against.
\$10K+ 218 startups (2%)	The scaled core — this thin layer anchors almost all of the \$15.4M in tracked MRR.

AI leads on volume; Mobile Apps convert best

Startup count vs. total MRR — top 8 categories



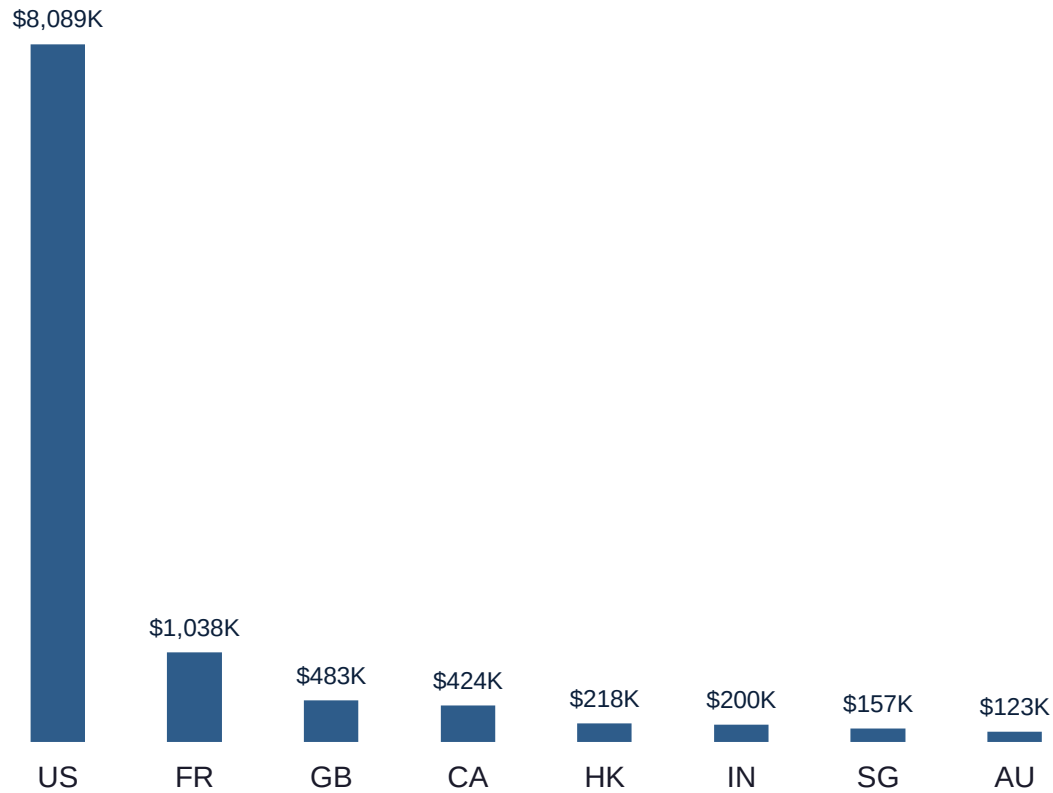
Conversion rate: % of startups with revenue



AI is the single largest category by count (1,430 startups, 16% of the directory) and by pooled MRR (\$2.25M), but only 58% of AI startups show any active revenue — in line with the dataset median. Mobile Apps is a fifth the size by count, yet 87% convert to paying revenue, the highest conversion rate of any major category.

The U.S. dominates value capture, not just headcount

■ Total MRR by country — top 8 markets



The per-startup value gap

\$4,882

Avg. MRR per U.S. startup
(1,657 tracked)

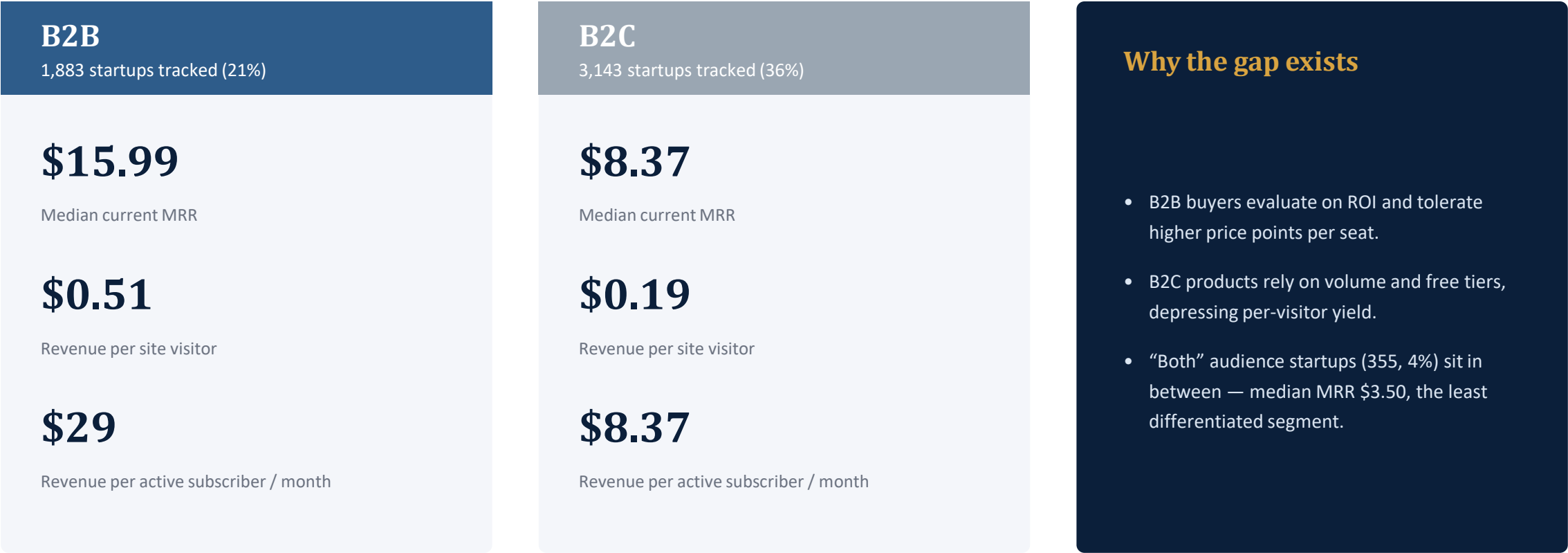
\$248

Avg. MRR per India startup
(807 tracked)

- The U.S. holds only 19% of records with a known country, but 53% of total tracked MRR — far more revenue than headcount would predict.
- India has the 2nd-highest startup count (807) but ranks 6th in total MRR — a ~20x gap in average revenue per startup vs. the U.S.
- 117 countries appear in the dataset overall; only 6,913 of 8,782 records (79%) have a country tag at all.

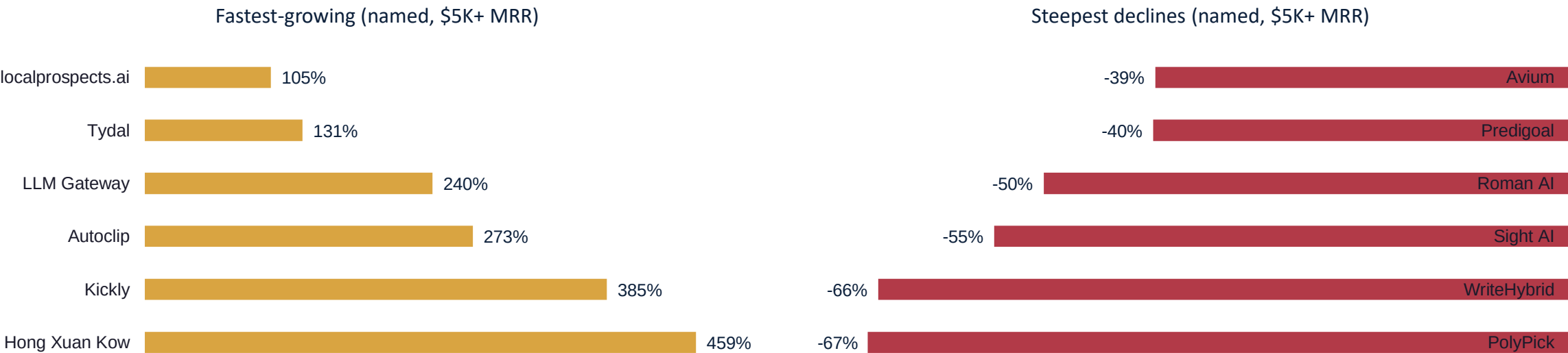
B2B startups monetize meaningfully better than B2C

Business model is a stronger predictor of monetization than category or geography. Across every efficiency metric in the dataset, B2B startups out-earn B2C peers — despite B2C outnumbering B2B nearly 2 to 1 by startup count.



Real momentum is scarce — and easy to mis-measure

■ 30-day MRR growth, startups with \$5K+ MRR (n = 878)



A necessary caution on growth %

Unfiltered, reported 30-day growth ranges from -13,000% to +12,983% — almost entirely a small-denominator artifact of startups moving off a near-zero base. Both charts above apply a \$5K+ MRR floor and exclude anonymized “Stealth Company” listings, so every name shown reflects a real, comparable swing in revenue — not a rounding effect.

A large, rational — but thin — micro-acquisition market

1,952

Startups listed for sale (22% of the directory)

\$137.0M

Combined asking price across all listings

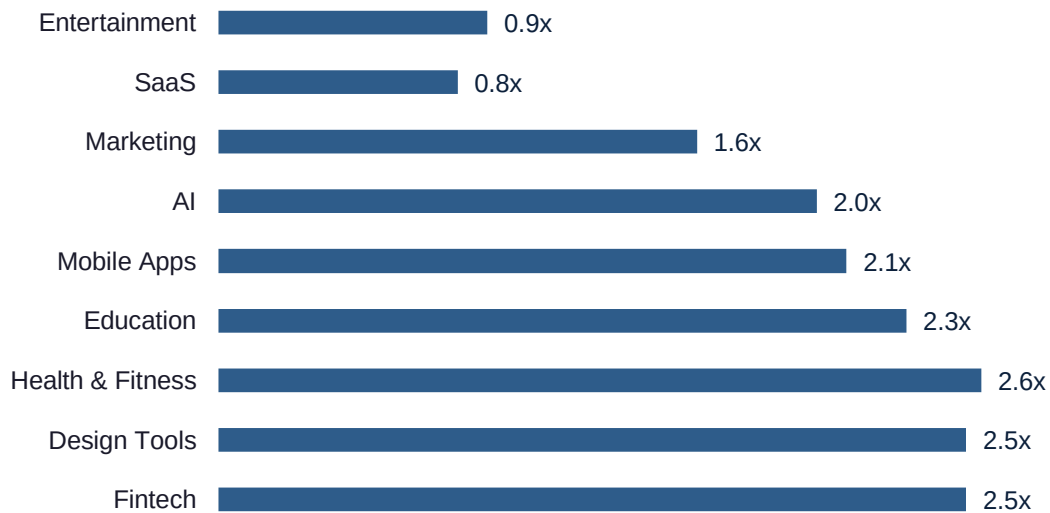
\$5,000

Median asking price — a long tail of small deals

0.81

Correlation of asking price with current MRR

■ Median revenue multiple by category (on-sale listings)



How to read this market

- Pricing is rational: sellers largely anchor to trailing revenue (0.81 correlation to MRR, 0.83 to 12-month revenue).
- But most listings are small: a \$5,000 median ask means the market is dominated by side-project sized deals, not venture-scale exits.
- Multiples reward stability over hype: Fintech and Health & Fitness command ~2.5x, while commodity SaaS and Entertainment trade at a discount (~0.8–0.9x).

Audience size is a weak predictor of revenue

It's tempting to treat social following or domain authority as a proxy for business health. The data says otherwise: neither metric meaningfully correlates with monthly recurring revenue.

$$r = 0.14$$

Domain Rating vs. MRR

A weak, near-negligible relationship. High domain authority (backlinks, SEO age) does not reliably signal a well-monetized product — organic traffic without conversion is common.

$$r = 0.01$$

X (Twitter) followers vs. MRR

Essentially zero correlation. Social reach and revenue are almost entirely independent in this dataset — large followings do not translate into paying customers on their own.

Read every number against these limits

■ Anonymized revenue

555 “Stealth Company” records (6.3% of the dataset) carry no name, category or country — yet represent 27% of total MRR. Category and geography totals in this deck exclude them, understating true market size.

■ Sparse enrichment fields

Value proposition, problem solved, pricing model, persona and audience type are founder-submitted and optional — roughly 40% of records leave one or more blank. Treat category-level splits as directional, not exhaustive.

■ Single-snapshot growth %

mrr_growth_30d_pct is a point-in-time change and highly sensitive to a low starting base; 2,149 records (24%) have no growth value at all, typically new or dormant listings.

■ Marketplace, not census

TrustMRR only includes startups that opt in and connect a supported payment API — it is a sample of bootstrapped, API-connected businesses, not the full software market.

What to do with this picture of the market

01

Benchmark against the top decile, not the average.

With 97% of MRR held by the top 10% of startups, a dataset-wide average overstates what a typical listing is worth. Use category- and audience-specific medians instead.

02

Favor B2B and high-conversion categories when screening opportunities.

B2B monetizes visitors 2.7x better than B2C; Mobile Apps converts 87% of listings to revenue vs. 41–58% for other major categories.

03

Treat U.S.-based, revenue-verified listings as the reference tier.

The U.S. captures a disproportionate share of MRR per startup; buyers and operators elsewhere should expect a real geography discount, not just a smaller pool.

04

Use asking-price-to-MRR ratios, not follower counts, to sanity-check deals.

Acquisition pricing already tracks realized revenue closely ($r = 0.81$); domain rating and social reach add little diagnostic value on their own.